

Make no Mistake

The voters of Karnataka are unlikely to go for a hung assembly knowing fully well its implications as seen in the previous three coalition governments, one of which could only last for a week ("Gung-ho About a Hung House", May 12).

D.B.N. MURTHY, *Bangalore*

Looks Matter

Your reviewer may call Shobhaa De's book *Superstar India* "bland, featureless, wobbly and uncertain", but he must be aware of the fact that her readers will accept her book due to her "sultry looks and celebrity status", as she herself admits ("De Turns into Night", May 12). The rest is immaterial.

AMITABH THAKUR, *Lucknow*

Like other publications, INDIA TODAY should start giving gradings in the form of stars to books and films, so as to indicate their worth without the readers having to go through the tedious process of poring over their lengthy reviews.

SHANTI PRAKASH KARIR,

on e-mail

Hope on Sticks

There are people who never learn or repent ("The Fourteen-Year Hitch", May 12). One of them is K.P.S. Gill. He just sat there Nero-like while the hockey empire burnt like Rome around him.

J. AKSHAY, *Secunderabad*

Gill's removal, the suspension of HHF and Aslam Sher Khan being asked to look into hockey's affairs has made one hopeful. The players of the past as well

as the present should now work together to revive the game's lost glory.

M.M. KALE, *on e-mail*

Mark of Market

Consumerism amongst India's middle class has exceeded the expectations of global players ("India Profitable", May 12). The fact that today they are bending over backwards to customise their products and devise strategies to suit the needs of the people, is ample proof of India's

growing importance in the global market.

NALINI VIJAYARAGHAVAN,

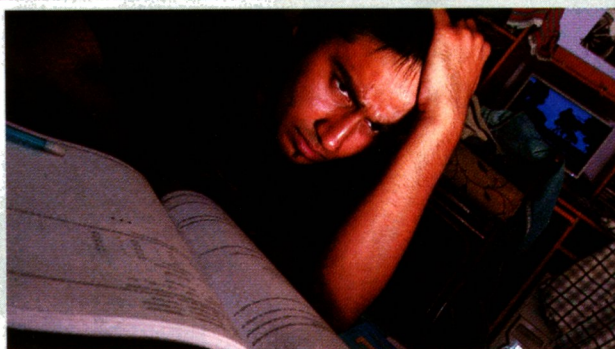
Thiruvananthapuram

Celestial Achievement

By putting 10 satellites in orbit, ISRO has conquered yet another space frontier for India ("Scoring a Perfect Ten", May 12). In the midst of grim news like starvation deaths and farmer suicides, the organisation has given us a reason to celebrate.

S. BALAKRISHNAN, *Jameshedpur*

BRIDGE THE GAP



Most parents today have forgotten the time-tested principle that there can be no short-cuts to success ("Teen Suicides", April 28). They should know that not getting admission into IITs and IIMs is not the end of the world. There are a plethora of alternative careers available.

HARISH KUMAR PRAJAPATI, *Saharanpur*

Increasing competition between blood-relatives, an urge for a lifestyle beyond the reach of the breadwinner of the family coupled with eroding family values have led to increasing suicide cases among youngsters.

V.K. NAIR, *Mumbai*

Lack of communication between parents and their wards can be one of the major reasons behind such drastic steps on the children's part. They must sit down and talk to their children about their daily lives so that they feel at ease and are able to discuss their problems without any hesitation.

K.M.G. VIVEKANANDAM, *Madurai*

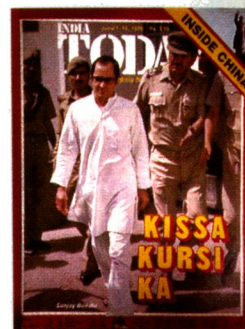
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30

Years Ago in India Today

JUNE 1-15, 1978



Case of the Missing Film

With his expected release from judicial custody in Delhi's Tihar Jail on June 5, Sanjay Gandhi, the errant son of former prime minister Indira Gandhi, has discovered that he is not destined for political martyrdom. The initial, sporadic outbursts of vocal protests over the Supreme Court's decision on May 5 to cancel Sanjay's bail for one month in the *Kissa Kursi Ka* (KKK) case (in which he is the principal accused), have subsided as rapidly as they have surfaced.



Sanjay Gandhi Even the news-starved media has abandoned him with equal promptness after tersely informing the public about his eating, sleeping and reading habits during his internment as a temporary guest of the Government. More significantly, it is also a measure of Mrs Gandhi's new political strategy that she has chosen to remain ominously silent about her son's dramatic detention last month.

—DIB Bhatt

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